

Eng named interim after transit chief steps down

MBTA leader will fill two roles; Tibbits-Nutt faced controversies

By Samantha J. Gross, Matt Stout, and Jaime Moore-Carrillo

GLOBE STAFF

MBTA general manager Phil Eng was named interim secretary of the state Department of Transportation on Thursday after Monica Tibbits-Nutt stepped down from the post. Eng, the third person to serve in the role in as many years, will also continue to lead the T.

Tibbits-Nutt's departure, after less than two years in the job, comes on the heels of the department's disputed contract to redevelop the state's 18 highway service plazas. The losing finalist for the bid sued MassDOT and the winner pulled out.

Tibbits-Nutt will stay on as a paid adviser through the end of the year "to ensure a smooth and efficient transition," according to a press release. She was not quoted in the release, nor did she appear at a press conference at the department's headquarters Thursday.

Governor Maura Healey told reporters at the State House that she did not ask Tibbits-Nutt to step down. The governor also insisted her exit was unrelated to several controversies during Tibbits-Nutt's tenure, including the service plaza contract or Tibbits-Nutt's comments last year that the state could start charging tolls to drivers entering its borders.

"No, absolutely not," Healey said, saying officials "wish her all the best in her next chapter."

Tibbits-Nutt is the fifth member of Healey's Cabinet to leave or announce a departure since

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Governor Maura Healey said she wasn't concerned about Phil Eng holding two titles. "He gets it done," she said.

Once a Trump ally, Bolton now indicted

Accused of mishandling classified information

By Devlin Barrett and Glenn Thrush

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — John R. Bolton, the national security hawk and former adviser to President Trump who became one of his most outspoken critics, was indicted by a federal grand jury in Maryland on Thursday on charges of mishandling classified information.

An 18-count indictment accused Bolton of using personal email and a messaging app to share more than 1,000 pages of "diary" notes about his day-to-day activities as Trump's national security adviser in 2018 and 2019. Many of those notes included "national defense information," including details classified as top secret, the indictment charged.

Trump and his former aide parted bitterly toward the end of his first term. "He's a bad guy," Trump said in answer to a question from a reporter at the White House about Bolton. "That's the way it goes."

While Bolton is part of a string of perceived enemies of the president to become prosecutorial targets, the federal investigation into him gained momentum during the Biden administration, when US intelligence agencies gathered what former officials have described as troubling evidence.

In recent weeks, Trump has removed or re-

BOLTON, Page A7



John Bolton was President Trump's national security adviser.

Harvard's finances 'challenging'

Endowment generated large return but school had first deficit in years, with more cuts ahead

By Aidan Ryan and Diti Kohli

GLOBE STAFF

Harvard University said Thursday that its endowment posted the largest annual return since 2021 and donations jumped, shoring up its coffers amid mounting financial challenges including its battle with the White House.

But university leaders warned

that tougher times are ahead. Its investment gains helped the university weather a turbulent few months, but Harvard saw a deficit for the first time since the pandemic and may be approaching the limits of its ability to offset billions in potential lost federal revenue.

The university is bracing to pay millions more in taxes on its \$56.9

billion endowment starting next year, and it expects to see fewer dollars from Washington for research across academia. Harvard is also contending with attacks from the Trump administration targeting billions in research grants, along with its accreditation and international student population. It is now months into negotiations for a deal with ad-

ministration officials.

Harvard's investment portfolio — made up mostly of private equity, hedge funds, and stocks — generated a return of 11.9 percent in the year ended June 30, according to its annual financial report. That compares with a 9.6 percent gain in the prior year.

HARVARD, Page A10



ALEX GOODLETT/ASSOCIATED PRESS

MAGA hats were everywhere at a Turning Point USA rally in September at Utah State University, part of a campus tour.

KIRK'S MOVEMENT FINDS NEW RESOLVE

After his death, Turning Point draws millions of followers and donations pour in

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru

GLOBE STAFF

BLACKSBURG, Va. — Joel Beasley was a casual fan of Charlie Kirk. Occasionally, a clip of the right-wing activist debating people or quoting the Bible would pop up in his social media feed.

But when Kirk was assassinated on Sept. 10 at Utah Valley University, Beasley felt called to political action.

It's part of the reason why the 18-year-old drove 45 minutes to Virginia Tech's campus in Blacksburg last month to attend his first Turning Point USA event. The organization Kirk founded — which is focused on spreading con-

servatism among young people by visiting college campuses, registering voters, and cataloguing alleged liberal bias among professors — has remained active following his death.

In the past month, the movement has reached new levels of exposure. Kirk has posthumously gained millions of social media followers, donations are rolling in at Turning Point, and the organization reports receiving 120,000 inquiries about starting new chapters at high schools and colleges.

For Beasley, Kirk's death wasn't just significant to his personal political journey: it was an inflection point for the entire country, especially among young Americans.

"There definitely was movement back towards conservatism beforehand," Beasley said. "But I do think his death is going to act as a catalyst to make that happen faster."

For conservatives, momentum could spur more engagement with young voters — a key group that President Trump, with Kirk's help, made inroads with in 2024.

A poll conducted in early October by Harvard's Center for American Political Studies showed Kirk has the highest net favorability rating among voters of any political figure tested, including Trump, Joe Biden, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, and New York

KIRK, Page A7

As shutdown drags on, many in need left out of the loop

By Jim Puzzanghera and Julian E.J. Sorapuru

GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When people fear that US Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents have taken a family member into custody, they frequently contact their local member of Congress. Staffers for those lawmakers then reach out to a special ICE office to try to track down any information.

"They walk into our office here in Springfield and they say, 'I don't know if it was Springfield police, I don't know if it was State Police. I don't know if it was a federal agent,'" said Jack Chamberland, a spokesperson for Representative Richard Neal, a Springfield Democrat.

"So our role was facilitating the connection with them and their loved one by figuring out who took them and where they're being held."

But since the federal government shut down on Oct. 1, the lines of communication to the ICE Office of Congressional Relations are silent. And that has stopped the flow of crucial information.

"Due to the current hiatus in federal funding . . . staff are currently out of the office and unable to respond to emails, phone calls, or perform other work-related duties," reads part of a bounceback email from the office, in red print with several typos.

SHUTDOWN, Page A6

A TIME TO GRIEVE



DAVID GUTTENFELDER/NEW YORK TIMES

Mourners gathered Thursday in Kfar Saba for the funeral of Tamir Nimrodi, an Israeli soldier and former hostage whose body was returned. Israel marked a national day of commemoration for the victims of the Hamas-led Oct. 7, 2023, attack and the subsequent war. **A3.**

State officials said they will crack down on the "street takeovers" that have unfolded in and around Boston. **B1.**

Eye injuries are rising in pickleball players because of the game's speed. **A2.**

Several potential candidates are con-

sidering a run for the congressional seat Seth Moulton is vacating. **B1.**

With Halloween fast approaching, here are 13 spooky places to explore. **G1.**

Ace Frehley, the original lead guitarist for Kiss, died at age 74 after a fall. **C9.**

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Weather and Comics, G8-9.

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